



Fredrik Pahlman

PRODUCT & DESIGN LEADER ·
DISCOVERY · AI · HANDS-ON CRAFT ·
TEAM EXCELLENCE

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Product and design leader with 12+ years working across craft, strategy, and organisational change. Driven by missions that matter, including education technology where the gap between potential and reality is still wide. Known for combining hands-on building with strategic leadership, integrating AI into design practice early, and creating the conditions where high-performing design teams raise the bar on quality and speed.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Design Leadership

AI-first Ways of Working

Product Strategy

Continuous Discovery

Team Coaching & Growth

Cross-functional Alignment

Hands-on Prototyping

Outcome-oriented Prioritisation

Design Craft & Quality

Ambiguity Navigation

Entrepreneurial Mindset

EXPERIENCE

UX & Discovery Lead

Sep 2025, Present

SLEEP CYCLE · Consumer wellness app · 40 people · Discovery lead across 4 product teams · Gothenburg

- Led discovery and UX across four product teams in a 40-person company, building a continuous practice from scratch and sustaining an unbroken weekly interview cadence for 18 months.
- Actively integrated AI into design practice: using AI-assisted synthesis, opportunity mapping, and design critique to accelerate decisions and raise the quality bar, not just reduce effort.
- Worked hands-on across research, prototyping, and strategy, driving experiments and iterating quickly rather than waiting for perfect conditions, a deliberate choice to lead through doing.
- Built JTBD-based archetypes and a shared Notion knowledge system that gave all four teams a live, accessible body of customer insight to act on.

Senior Product Designer

Oct 2024, Present

SLEEP CYCLE · Consumer wellness app · Gothenburg

- Contributed to product direction through a combination of strong craft and strategic framing, moving design decisions upstream into discovery, not downstream from spec.
 - Developed a reputation for connecting user insight to product opportunity, which led to taking on the Discovery and UX Lead scope in parallel.
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VP of Product

Feb 2022, Oct 2024

CARBONCLOUD · Climate tech SaaS · B2B · Grew from 10 to 45 people · Gothenburg

- Joined when the company was 10 people and grew with it to 45, taking on full ownership of product strategy, roadmap, and a product team of three at peak.
 - Defined how CarbonCloud's platform created value for food industry customers navigating carbon transparency requirements, working closely with founders and GTM leadership to keep product strategy grounded in market reality.
 - Introduced and evolved product-led growth frameworks, leading product strategy, roadmapping, and growth modelling in close collaboration with founders and commercial leadership.
 - Built product processes suited to a fast-moving scaleup: lightweight, ownership-driven, and fast enough to keep pace with commercial reality, with clarity on when to slow down to get the problem right.
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VP of User Experience

Nov 2021, Feb 2022

CARBONCLOUD · Climate tech SaaS · B2B · Gothenburg

- Established the UX function from an early stage, creating research and design practices that scaled as the product and team grew.
 - Scope expanded to VP of Product within four months, reflecting growing strategic contribution beyond design.
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User Experience Designer

Feb 2020, Nov 2021

CARBONCLOUD · Early-stage climate tech · Gothenburg

- Joined as an early employee and shaped the product from the ground up, conducting customer research, defining UX principles, and building the design foundation for a complex B2B data platform.
 - Operated in a high-ambiguity environment with minimal process, developing judgment about when to move fast and when to slow down and understand the problem more deeply.
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Chief Design Officer

Jan 2017, Feb 2020

INUSE · Design & innovation consultancy · Gothenburg

- Elevated to CDO to lead the company's design capability across the Group of Directors, responsible for quality, strategic positioning, and the professional development of a multi-disciplinary design team.
 - Drove the evolution of design competence as inUse grew from a 60-person senior-only agency to a 120-person organisation capable of recruiting and developing junior talent, introducing skills-based recruitment testing, structured competence sharing, and assignment processes that balanced learning with delivery quality.
 - Shaped how inUse engaged with clients at the intersection of design, technology, and business strategy, growing the firm's credibility as a product thinking partner, not just a UX vendor.
 - Built and maintained a culture of rigorous craft combined with commercial pragmatism, balancing quality with real-world constraints.
 - Personally coached and developed both senior individual contributors and directors, with several progressing into leadership roles, reflecting a consistent approach to raising the bar on craft and ownership, not just headcount.
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UX Director

Aug 2014, Jan 2016

INUSE · Design & innovation consultancy · Gothenburg

- Responsible for design quality in the area of physical and digital products, coaching designers on client projects and setting standards for interaction quality.
 - Helped grow the firm's practice in complex product environments including medical devices and enterprise tools.
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Interaction Designer

Nov 2012, Aug 2014

INUSE · Gothenburg

- Worked on medical companion app design and UX for medical personal devices, developing a foundation in high-stakes, complex interaction problems where clarity and safety are non-negotiable.
- Built early habits of connecting design decisions to user outcomes and business reality, which shaped the strategic trajectory of the career ahead.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

CLIMATE TECH SCALEUP

Joined CarbonCloud as first UX hire at 10 people, grew to VP of Product as the company scaled to 45, managing a product

DISCOVERY AT SCALE

Built and sustained a continuous discovery practice across four product teams at Sleep Cycle for 18 months, including an unbroken

team of three and building product strategy and discovery capability from scratch.

weekly interview cadence that made customer insight a reliable input to product decisions.

DESIGN LEADERSHIP

As CDO at inUse, led a 120-person design organisation across five Design Directors, coaching a leadership layer and raising design maturity from delivery-focused execution to strategic contribution.

AI-ENABLED WAYS OF WORKING

Actively integrated AI into design and discovery workflows at Sleep Cycle, including synthesis, opportunity mapping, and critique, treating AI as a way to raise quality and speed simultaneously, not just automate tasks.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Industrial Design Engineering · Chalmers University of Technology · Minor in Cognitive Ergonomics 2005 – 2010

TOOLS & METHODS

DISCOVERY & RESEARCH

Continuous Discovery, JTBD, opportunity mapping, assumption testing, qual & quant research

PRODUCT & STRATEGY

Outcome-based roadmaps, OKRs, product strategy, North Star framing, B2B SaaS

AI & TOOLING

Claude, ChatGPT, Figma, Notion AI, Miro, Genway, Userology, Midjourney